

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)
Côte d'Ivoire Office**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Youth and Adolescent Development

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Ms. Juliette Nsensele Faida
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Chief Youth and Adolescent Development.

3. Background information

The fundamental mission of UNICEF is to promote the rights of every child, everywhere, in everything the organization does — in programs, in advocacy and in operations. The equity strategy, emphasizing the most disadvantaged and excluded children and families, translates this commitment to children's rights into action. For UNICEF, equity means that all children have an opportunity to survive, develop and reach their full potential, without discrimination, bias or favoritism. To the degree that any child has an unequal chance in life — in its social, political, economic, civic and cultural dimensions — her or his rights are violated. There is growing evidence that investing in the health, education, and protection of a society's most disadvantaged citizens — addressing inequity — not only will give all children the opportunity to fulfill their potential but also will lead to sustained growth and stability of countries. This is why the focus on equity is so vital. It accelerates progress towards realizing the human rights of all children, which is

the universal mandate of UNICEF, as outlined by the Convention on the Rights of the Child, while also supporting the equitable development of nations.

Globally, UNICEF supports the systematic development of a breadth of transferable skills, at scale, across the life course and through multiple learning pathways – formal, non-formal and community based. Under the Strategic Plan 2018-2021, Goal Area 2, UNICEF focuses on improving systems that develop the skills of girls and boys from early childhood to adolescence, in order to promote equitable learning, personal empowerment, active citizenship, non-violence, gender equality and employability, both in and out of schools. UNICEF's ADAP and Education Strategies highlights our commitment to providing multiple engagement and learning pathways for adolescents by introducing and scaling up innovative approaches that will enable UNICEF to respond to the increasingly important and critical period in which children transition to adulthood.

Adolescents and Young people represent over 30% of the population in Côte d'Ivoire. Poverty, limited access to education and skills development opportunities, opportunity costs, a mismatch between training programs and labor market needs, and harmful gender norms are among the main reasons for their increasing vulnerability. According to the National Employment Survey, 35% of youth are not in education, employment, or training. Despite progress achieved in the sector of education during the last decade, adolescents and young people continue to face limited access (and completion) to quality education and training opportunities, leading to poor employability, an increased risk of social exclusion, with consequences in terms of poverty, marginality, empowerment, and vulnerability to radical and violent discourse. These risks are particularly high for the 52.8% of adolescent girls and young women and the 36.2% of adolescent boys and young men aged 15-24 who are illiterate. They are also high for the 35% of adolescents and young people aged 15-24 who are not in school, employment, or training (NEET), a situation that affects 44.2% of girls and 44.1% of adolescents and young people in rural areas. It is estimated that 450,000 young people among those who have been able to attend leave the school system without a diploma or qualification annually.

The Government of Côte d'Ivoire has taken several initiatives to promote the empowerment and socio-professional integration of young people. Since 2019, UNICEF Côte d'Ivoire is supporting the Ministry of Youth to design and implement a tailored multi-sectoral civic service program to empower and improve employability of the most disadvantaged, marginalized adolescent girls and young women through the Girl Power Initiative. In 2021, encouraged by the results, the government of Côte d'Ivoire decided to scale up the implementation of the model in 14 regions to reach more young people with empowerment and employability programs, through the government's 2023-2025 youth plan. UNICEF Côte d'Ivoire country office is currently contributing to these efforts, through technical and financial support.

The government of Côte d'Ivoire is also working to leverage the potential of the green and blue entrepreneurship to address the multiple crisis of youth unemployment, the need to develop skills for the fourth Industrial revolution, greening the environment while contributing to a healthy planet, ultimately leading to prosperity for all. In 2020, the country prepared a National Integrated Strategy for promoting green and blue jobs to explore job creation niches and create opportunities in the green and blues sectors, including for young people. To contribute to the implementation of the above-mentioned strategy, UNICEF and the Ministry of Youth launched Green Yoma in 2022. Yoma is a digital marketplace where youth can build their futures by actively engaging in social impact tasks as well as learning to earning opportunities. Green Yoma seeks to respond to the unemployment and well-being crisis by innovatively engaging young people in concrete pathways from learning to earning that build their skills and connect them to livelihoods in the blue and green economies.

Purpose for the job:

Under direct supervisor of Chief of Youth and Adolescent (P4), the Adolescents and Youth Development Specialist (Innovations) will be responsible for the following key functions/accountabilities:

- preparation and support to the development and scaling up of the innovation and employability programs
- managing of the innovation and employability programs. He/ she will provide technical guidance and management support throughout the programming processes to facilitate the administration and achievement of results to improve agency and employability, particularly for adolescents' girls, young women and other marginalized, disadvantage and excluded groups of young people
-

The Structure is Represented as following:

OFFICE OF THE REPRESENTATIVE: Led by the Representative (D1)

- People & Culture Section. Led by the People & Culture Manager (P4)
- Resource Mobilization and Partnerships Section. Led by the Chief Res Mob. & Partnerships (P4)
- Social Policy Section. Led by Social Policy Specialist (NO-3)
- External Communications Section. Led by Chief of Communications (P4)

PROGRAMMES: Led by the Deputy Representative Programmes (P5).

- Programme Coordination: Emergency Specialist (NO-3), Gender Specialist (NO-3), Construction Specialist (P3), Budget Officer (NO-2)
- Social Behavior Change Section. Led by Social Behavior Change Specialist (P3)
- Planning Monitoring & Evaluation Section. Led by Chief PM&E (P4)
- Education Section. Led by Chief Education (P4)
- Health & HIV/AIDS Section. Led by Chief Health & HIV/AIDS (P4)
- Nutrition Section. Led by Chief Nutrition (P4)
- WASH Section. Led by Chief WASH (P4)
- Child Protection Section. Led by Chief Child Protection (P4)
- Youth and Adolescent Development: led by Chief Youth & Adolescent Development (P4).

FIELD OFFICES: Programmes implementations. Oversight by the Representative

- MAN Field Office. Led by Chief Field Office (NO-3)
- KORHOGO Field Office. Led by Chief Field Office (NO-3)

OPERATIONS: Led by the Deputy Representative Operations (P5)

- Finance Unit. Led by Finance Officer (NO-2)
- Admin Unit. Led by Admin Officer (NO-2)
- ICT Unit. Led by ICT Specialist (NO-3)
- Supply & Logistics Unit. Led by Supply & Logistics Manager (P4).

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

Key functions, accountabilities and related duties/tasks:

- Strategy design and improvement of the programs
- Programme management, monitoring and delivery of results.
- Networking and partnership building.
- Innovation, knowledge management and capacity building

Strategy design and improvement of the Adolescents and Youth Development Specialist (Innovations) programs

- Participate in strategic program discussion on the planning of A&Y innovation and employability programs. Contribute to the preparation of the program proposals for the innovation and employability programs, ensuring alignment with UNICEF's Strategic Plans and Country Programme and coherence/integration with the UN Development Assistance Framework (UNDAF), regional strategies and national priorities.

Programme management, monitoring and delivery of results

- Plan and collaborate with internal colleagues, external partners and young people to establish monitoring benchmarks, performance indicators and other UNICEF/UN system indicators to assess/strengthen performance accountability, coherence and delivery of concrete and sustainable results for the innovation and employability programs.
- Participate in monitoring and evaluation exercises and reviews with the government, other counterparts and young people to assess progress and to determine required action/interventions to achieve results.
- Identify lessons learned and use knowledge gained for development planning and timely intervention to achieve goals.
- Prepare regular and mandated program reports for management, donors and partners to keep them informed of program progress
- Assist in providing technical guidance and operational support to government counterparts, NGO partners, UN system partners and country office partners and donors on interpretation, application and understanding of UNICEF policies, strategies, processes and best practices and approaches on education and related issues to support program management, implementation and delivery of results.

Advocacy, networking and partnership building for adolescents & youth innovation and employability Network

- Assist in building and sustaining effective close working partnerships with relevant government counterparts, national stakeholders, global partners, donors, private sectors, academia and youth organizations and networks through active networking, advocacy and effective communication to build capacity, exchange knowledge/expertise and to reinforce cooperation to achieve sustainable and broad results on education programmes.
- Prepare communication and information materials for CO program advocacy to promote awareness, establish partnerships and support fund raising for the Youth & adolescents' innovation, engagement and employability for sustainable development programs.
- Participate in appropriate inter-agency (UNCT) discussions on youth and adolescent and related issues to collaborate with inter-agency partners/colleagues on UNDAF planning and preparation of programs/projects ensuring organizational position, interests and priorities are fully considered and integrated in the UNDAF process in development planning and agenda setting.
- Support in the development of effective private sector engagement strategies for adolescents and youth and adolescents' engagement and employability.

Innovation, knowledge management and capacity building

- Apply and introduce innovative approaches and good practices to build the capacity of partners and stakeholders and to support the implementation and delivery of concrete and sustainable program results.
- Keep abreast, research, benchmark, and implement best practices in adolescents and youth development and employability management. Assess, institutionalize and share best practices and knowledge learned.
- Contribute to the development and implementation of policies and procedures to ensure optimum efficiency and efficacy of sustainable programs and projects.
- Contribute to the organization and implementation of capacity building initiatives to enhance the competencies of clients/stakeholders to promote sustainable results on education and related programs/projects.

Impact of Results

The efficiency and efficacy of support to be provided by the Fellow in the preparation, planning, implementation, reporting and documentation of the program will contribute to the consolidation of a nationally owned and led innovative program model to achieve sustainable results to improve agency, empowerment and employability of adolescents and young people at scale.

Success will contribute to maintaining and enhancing the leadership and credibility of the organization to provide program services for adolescents and young people, particularly girls, that promotes greater social equality in the country.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

An advanced university degree (Master) in one of the following fields is required: social and behavioral science, sociology, anthropology, psychology, education, development or another relevant technical field

Work experience

Experience working in adolescent's development or education sectors. Experience working in a developing country is an asset.

Languages

Fluency in English and French is required.

Competencies

Professionalism: Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of subject matter;

Teamwork: Works collaboratively with colleagues to achieve organizational goals;

Communication: Speaks and write clearly and effectively

Core Values attributes

- Care
- Respect
- Integrity
- Trust
- Accountability
- sustainability

Functional Competencies

- Persuading and influencing
- Applying technical expertise
- Learning and researching
- Planning and organizing

Core competencies skills

- Demonstrates Self Awareness and Ethical Awareness
- Works Collaboratively with others
- Builds and Maintains Partnerships
- Innovates and Embraces Change
- Thinks and Acts Strategically
- Drives to achieve impactful results
- Manages ambiguity and complexity

6. Content and methodology of the supervision

The Office will organize a general induction and a work-related orientation led by the supervisor for the first 30 to 90 days.

The supervisor is a former young leader grown into an Adolescents Development specialist. She has over 18 years of experience working with and for young people at country, regional and global levels. During the last 11 years, the supervisor has directly supervised 11 Young professional in Adolescents Holistic Development within and outside UNICEF. 5 among them have ascended to influential managerial positions within international organizations

7. Living conditions in the country

A country of about 29 million inhabitants, Cote d'Ivoire is one of the most developed countries in West Africa, accounting for more than 40% of the West African Economic and Monetary Union's GDP and exports. The country remains politically stable and recently organized local elections that remained mostly peaceful. The official language of the country is French, and the diplomatic and expatriate community is large and diverse.

UNICEF main Office is in Abidjan, the economic capital and largest city of the country. A cultural crossroads of West Africa, Abidjan is characterized by a high level of industrialization and urbanization. The transport network is developed and offers safe options to commute within the city and between major towns.

Abidjan features a tropical wet and dry climate with a long rainy season from March to July, a short rainy season from September to December, and three dry months (January, February and August).

Different types of long-term accommodation are available in Abidjan: standalone houses, houses in gated compounds, apartments. These could be furnished and/or fully serviced, or unfurnished. Electricity and running water are available, although this may not be 24hrs in few areas of Abidjan. Costs are reasonable but vary per location.

Upon arrival, you staff reside in a hotel or apartment until they get permanent housing. Long term accommodation can be found through available Real estate agencies.

The Security Level in Abidjan is classified as Moderate (Level 3) as per the UN security management system in Cote d'Ivoire. The political situation remains relatively calm, and the next general elections will take place in 2025. Terrorism remains a concern especially in the North part of the country bordering Mali and Burkina Faso. Despite some security challenges, there is a quick response Police service and effective fire services.